Cameron Pattison

Vanderbilt University
Department of Philosophy
Nashville, TN 37240
Last updated: October 2026

Email: cameron.pattison@vanderbilt.edu
Website: campattison.github.io
Phone: +1 (802) 461-5799

AREAS

Areas of Specialization: Political Philosophy, Social Epistemology, Philosophy of AI
Areas of Competence: Ethics, Epistemology, Islamic Philosophy, Ancient Philosophy, Logic

EDUCATION

Ph.D. Philosophy, Vanderbilt University 2023–2029 (expected)
Ph.D. candidate; prospectus defended October 2026
Dissertation: Audience-facing Duties in the Ethics of Speaking for Others
Committee: Robert Talisse (chair), Tony Chemero, Jacob Barrett, David Thorstad, and Seth Lazar (external, Johns Hopkins University)
Teaching Certificate (Spring 2025)
AI and Data Ethics (AIDE) Fellowship, Northeastern University (Summer 2025)

M.A. Philosophy, Boston College 2021–2023

B.A. Philosophy, with honors, Colorado College, *Magna Cum Laude* 2014–2018

PUBLICATIONS

Peer-Reviewed and Edited Volumes

Zainaldin, J. L., Pattison, C., Marai, M., Wu, J., & Schiefsky, M. J. (forthcoming). "Evaluating LLM-Based Translation of a Low-Resource Technical Language: The Medical and Philosophical Greek of Galen." *Language Resources and Evaluation*. (Accepted October 2026.) arXiv:2602.24119.

Pattison, C., Manuali, L., & Lazar, S. (2026). "Blind Refusal: Language Models Refuse to Help Users Evade Unjust, Absurd, and Illegitimate Rules." *Proceedings of the Conference on Language Modeling (COLM 2026)*.

Pattison, C. (2026). "Non-Ideal Foundations for Preference-Based AI Alignment." *Philosophy & Technology*, 39(2), 97.

Pattison, C. (2025). "Justin Humphreys: *Inventing the Imagination*" (book review). *Graduate Faculty Philosophy Journal*.

Pattison, C. (2024). "Revelation in al-Fārābī's Virtuous City." In *Mind, Soul and the Cosmos in the High Middle Ages*, Springer Studies in the History of Philosophy.

Pattison, C., Olea, C., Tucker, H., Phelan, J., Zhang, S., Lieb, M., Schmidt, D., & White, J. (2024). "EPÉE: Evaluating Personified Expert Effectiveness." *CS & IT Conference Proceedings*.

Public Philosophy

Pattison, C., Ricks, V., & Wihbey, J. (2025). "How AI-Driven Search May Reshape Democracy, Economics, and Human Agency." *Tech Policy Press.*

Under Review

Pattison, C., Boulos, M., Kolt, N., Li, C., Piccardi, T., & Lazar, S. "The Agentic Web Requires New Normative Infrastructure." arXiv:2606.10711. Under review.

Working Papers

Pattison, C. "Representative Already."

Pattison, C. "Credence Preservation Error: An Epistemic Objective for Evaluating Stand-In Summaries."

RESEARCH

Researcher, ANU MINT Lab — *Evading Unjust Policy* 2025–present

Investigating compliance overspill in LLM safety systems — cases where AI refusals block ethically and legally permissible actions. Designed evaluation dataset, LLM-as-judge pipeline, and operational validity gates. Paper ("Blind Refusal") published at COLM 2026.

Principal Investigator, Lacy-Fischer Interdisciplinary Research Grant 2025–present

Computational text analysis and topic modeling examining ideological differences in AI research across institutional contexts (with Sociology Department).

Researcher, Vanderbilt University, Levin Lab 2025–present

Experimental design and philosophical framing for AI-driven chatbot interventions aimed at improving students' moral reasoning.

Researcher, Vanderbilt & Harvard — The Galen Project 2024–present

Evaluating AI translations of ancient Greek medical texts against expert human translations using automated MT metrics, expert MQM annotation, and blind preference surveys (with Classics and the Center for Hellenic Studies).

Research Affiliate, ANU MINT Lab 2024–present

Editor, *Philosophy of Computing Newsletter* (weekly and monthly editions; 911 subscribers).

Researcher, Vanderbilt & Harvard — Source Analysis Engine Project 2024–present

Computational approaches to classical source analysis using multi-shot API prompting and vector similarity search.

Ethicist, Vanderbilt University, RPW Center 2023–2024

Ethical analysis and research design for IRB-approved study on vulnerability to AI-driven phishing attacks.

PRESENTATIONS

"Digital Representation: User-Delegated AI Agents as Informal Political Representatives," PPE Society Tenth Annual Meeting, New Orleans Nov 2026

"Blind Refusal," Conference on Language Modeling (COLM 2026), San Francisco Oct 2026

"From the Spheres to the Shining Air: How Prophetic Visions Work in al-Fārābī's *Virtuous City*," Colorado College Oct 2026

"Computational Approaches to Philosophical Text Analysis," Vanderbilt DSI Mar 2025

"AI Reasoning and the Taking Condition," Invited Talk, MINT Lab (ANU) Oct 2024

"Mimēsis in Early Islamic Philosophy," Int'l Society for Neoplatonic Studies Jun 2024

"Al-Fārābī on the Imagination," Boston College GSA Conference Mar 2024

"On 'Wanting' in *Gorgias* 467a–468e," Tennessee Philosophical Association Oct 2023

"Socrates' Critique of Interpretation in *Protagoras* 341e–348b," Boston College Apr 2023

TEACHING

Instructor of Record, Introduction to Philosophy (PHIL 1002W), Vanderbilt Fall 2026

Co-Director, *AI and the Human*, Vanderbilt, RPW Humanities Center 2024–present

Co-Director, AI Alignment Workshop, Vanderbilt University 2025–2026

Philosophy of Mind Directed Reading, Vanderbilt University 2024–2025

Teaching Assistant, General Logic, Vanderbilt University 2025

Teaching Assistant, Introduction to Philosophy, Vanderbilt University 2024

Teaching Assistant, Introduction to Ethics, Vanderbilt University 2024

English as a Foreign Language Instructor, Tayba Association for Orphans, Morocco 2022–2023

Assistant Director, Brunswick School Vermont 2019–2021

Designed and taught courses; strategic planning and administration for a new campus.

DIGITAL HUMANITIES

Citation Map — Open-source tool rendering a paper's forward-citation network as an interactive 3D map via OpenAlex [GitHub] 2026

ArXiv Research Analysis Pipeline — Automated download, topic modeling, and sentiment analysis of AI research papers [GitHub] 2025

PhilPapers AI Relevance Classifier — Classification of 5,000+ entries for Philosophy of AI relevance using GPT-4o 2025

Zotero Research Assistant — Conversational AI for literature exploration with semantic search [GitHub] 2025

Source Analysis Recommender — Computational source-relationship identification across Greek and Arabic philosophical texts [GitHub] 2025

Ibn Arabi Translation Project — Interactive parallel text edition with AI-assisted Arabic–English translation [Web] 2025

Classical Text Translation System — Ancient text translation with BLEU and LM-based evaluation [GitHub] 2024

Philosophy Indexer — Automated conceptual index generation across philosophical corpora [GitHub] 2024

Kantian Ethical Analysis Tool — Interactive universalizability testing and categorical imperative analysis [Web] 2024

EDITORIAL WORK

Communications and Resource Management, MINT Lab (ANU)	2024
Indexing, Stanford University Press — *Maimonides Guide of the Perplexed*	2023
Editor and Communications Director, Harvard Ibn Arabi Seminar	2021–2023
Editor in Chief, *Anamnesis Philosophy Journal*, Colorado College	2017–2018

SERVICE

Active Member, Minorities and Philosophy (MAP) Chapter, Vanderbilt	2025–present
Undergraduate Mentor, Undergraduate Mentoring Program, Vanderbilt	2025–present

FELLOWSHIPS AND AWARDS

Harold Stirling Vanderbilt Award ($5,000)	2026
Anchor Award for Research, Vanderbilt Graduate Student Council	2026
Berry Publication Prize	2026
Vanderbilt University Graduate School Travel Grant ($1,000)	2026
Liverpool-Vanderbilt Joint Research Seed Grant ($15,113) (w/David Thorstad and Robin McKenna)	2025–6
Lacy-Fischer Interdisciplinary Research Grant, PI ($6,700)	2025
AIDE Fellowship, Northeastern University	2025
Berry Publication Prize	2025
Vanderbilt Award for Doctoral Discovery (VADD) ($5,000)	2024
Vanderbilt University Graduate School Travel Grant	2024
Berry Publication Prize	2024
Berry First-Year Teaching Award	2024
Vanderbilt Philosophy Department Travel Grant	2024
Russell G. Hamilton Scholar	2023
Ernest Fortin Memorial Foundation Summer Grant	2022
J. Glen Gray Award, Colorado College	2018
Distinction in Philosophy, *Magna Cum Laude*, Colorado College	2018
Phi Beta Kappa	2018

AFFILIATIONS

Vanderbilt Lab for Immersive AI Translation (VALIANT)	2024–present
Machine Intelligence and Normative Theory (MINT) Lab, ANU	2024–present
American Philosophical Association, Central Division	2023–present
Tennessee Philosophical Association	2023–present

LANGUAGES

English — Native

Greek — Reading proficiency (UChicago Summer Institute, 2020; Class Abroad in Greece, 2017)

Arabic — Reading and speaking proficiency (Qasid Summer Program, Amman, 2024; Harvard Divinity School, 2022; AALIM Morocco, 2017)

Spanish — Reading and speaking proficiency

REFERENCES

Professor David Thorstad
Vanderbilt University
Department of Philosophy

Professor Allison McCarthy
Vanderbilt University Medical Center
Center for Biomedical Ethics and Society

Professor Jacob Barrett
Vanderbilt University
Department of Philosophy

Professor Charreau Bell
Vanderbilt University
Computer Science, School of Engineering

Professor Seth Lazar
Johns Hopkins University
Department of Philosophy

Professor Jesse Spencer-Smith
Vanderbilt University
Data Science Institute